The Noble Dhāraṇī Called Accomplishment through the Infinite Gateway

Āryānantamukhasādhakanāmadhāraṇī · Toh 914 · Derge Kangyur
འཕགས་པ་སྒོམ་ཟད་ཡས་པས་སགྲུབ་པ་ཞེས་བྱ་འཕྲིན་གྱི་ཟུང་།

The Noble Dhāraṇī Called Accomplishment through the Infinite Gateway, known in Sanskrit as Ārya Anantamukhasādhaka Nāma Dhāraṇī and in Tibetan as Phakpa Go Tha Yepay Druppa Zhejawai Zung, is a dhāraṇī scripture, a text centered on a sacred formula that is recited and retained to support memory, protection, and spiritual accomplishment. Its narrative opens at Vaiśālī, in the Kūṭāgāra Hall of the Great Forest, where the Buddha is accompanied by eight thousand monks and many bodhisattvas. There, mindful and fully aware, he relinquishes the formations of life and announces that he will pass into complete nirvāṇa in three months. He then asks Mahāmaudgalyāyana to gather the monks, setting the scene for the teaching of the dhāraṇī as part of his final instructions. This work is Toh 914 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the collection of dhāraṇī texts.

In the language of India: ārya anantamukhasādhāka nāma dhāraṇī
In the language of Tibet: The Noble Dhāraṇī Called Accomplishment through the Infinite Gateway.

Homage to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was dwelling at Vaiśālī, in the mansion of the Kūṭāgāra Hall in the Great Forest. He was together with a great Saṅgha of eight thousand monks and a great many bodhisattva great beings.

At that time the Blessed One, mindful and fully aware, relinquished the formations of life, declaring, "When these three months have passed, the Tathāgata will pass into complete nirvāṇa."

Then the Blessed One spoke to the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana: "Mahāmaudgalyāyana, go and gather here, in this mansion of the Kūṭāgāra Hall in the Great Forest, all the monks who dwell throughout the thousandfold world system."

The venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana replied, "Blessed One, so be it." Heeding the Blessed One, in that very instant, through the power of his own miraculous ability, he sat on the summit of Mount Meru and made his voice heard throughout the thousandfold world system:

"All you beings who are disciples of the Sugata,
Dwelling in this world system, listen!
Today, here, the Teacher will send down a rain of Dharma;
All who wish to listen, come here!"

At that time forty thousand monks gathered in the mansion of the Kūṭāgāra Hall in the Great Forest. When they had arrived and saw the Blessed One, they bowed their heads at the Blessed One's feet, circumambulated the Blessed One three times, and sat down to one side.

Then, in that very instant, through the power of the Buddha, the venerable Śāriputra thought, "Should I not perform a miraculous display such that, by performing it, all the monks who dwell throughout the great trichiliocosm, whether they follow the Śrāvaka Vehicle, the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle, or the Great Vehicle, will gather in the mansion of the Kūṭāgāra Hall in the Great Forest?"

Then the venerable Śāriputra performed such a miraculous display. When he had performed that miraculous display, all the monks who dwell throughout the great trichiliocosm, whether they followed the Śrāvaka Vehicle, the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle, or the Great Vehicle, gathered in the mansion of the Kūṭāgāra Hall in the Great Forest. When they had arrived and saw the Blessed One, they bowed their heads at the Blessed One's feet, circumambulated the Blessed One three times, and sat down to one side.

Then, in that very instant, the Blessed One spoke to the bodhisattva great beings, namely the bodhisattva great being called Amoghadarśin, Mañjuśrī Kumārabhūta, the bodhisattva great being Sarvāpāyajaha, the bodhisattva great being Sarvaśokatamonirghātana, the bodhisattva great being Sarvanīvaraṇaviṣkambhin, the bodhisattva great being Jālinīprabha, the bodhisattva great being Mind That Destroys the Darkness of All Lands, the bodhisattva great being noble Avalokiteśvara, the bodhisattva great being Mahāsthāmaprāpta, the bodhisattva great being Who Does Not Wholly Guard the Mind, the bodhisattva great being Gandhahastin, the bodhisattva great being Śūra, the bodhisattva great being Gaganagañja, the bodhisattva great being Amitābha, the bodhisattva great being Candraprabha, the bodhisattva great being Jñānaketu, the bodhisattva great being Bhadrapāla, the bodhisattva great being Sāgaramati, the bodhisattva great being Akṣayamati, the bodhisattva great being Vajragarbha, the bodhisattva great being Ākāśagarbha, the bodhisattva great being Samantabhadra, the bodhisattva

great being Vajrapāṇi, the bodhisattva great being Pratibhānakūṭa, and the bodhisattva great being Maitreya. He said, "Sons of noble family, today you must gather here, in this mansion of the Kūṭāgāra Hall in the Great Forest, all the bodhisattvas who dwell in the buddha fields of all ten directions, buddha fields as numerous as the sands of the river Ganges: those in their final existence, those bound to one more birth, those who are irreversible, those who have attained acceptance that phenomena are unborn, and those who are devoted through faith."

Then those bodhisattva great beings heeded the Blessed One and said, "Excellent, Blessed One, excellent!" In that very instant they made such a sign, and when they had made that sign, there came to the mansion of the Kūṭāgāra Hall in the Great Forest bodhisattvas in their final existence numbering hundreds of thousands of koṭis of nayutas, inexpressibly inexpressible hundreds of thousands of koṭis of nayutas. There came bodhisattvas bound to one more birth numbering ninety times a hundred thousand times ninety hundred thousand koṭis of nayutas; irreversible bodhisattvas numbering eighty thousand times a hundred hundred thousand koṭis of nayutas; bodhisattva great beings who had attained acceptance that phenomena are unborn numbering thirty hundred thousand times a hundred thousand koṭis of nayutas; and bodhisattva great beings devoted through faith numbering eight hundred thousand times a hundred thousand koṭis of nayutas. When all of them had arrived and saw the Blessed One, they bowed their heads at the Blessed One's feet, circumambulated the Blessed One three times, and sat down to one side.

Then the venerable Śāriputra saw that great assembly of bodhisattvas, and at that very instant he thought: "By what kind of question and answer will these bodhisattva great beings abandon all their doubts? How will they quickly attain unobstructed wisdom and eloquence? How will they hear the Dharma taught by all the tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly complete buddhas of buddha fields as numerous as the sands of the Ganges River, and, having heard it, retain it and not forget it until they fully awaken to unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening?

"How will they attain those four that are the pure conduct of bodhisattva great beings? What are the four? They are the purity of sentient beings, the purity of the Dharma, the purity of aspiration, and the purity of the buddha field. How will they attain these?

"How will they attain the four excellent qualities that make one pleasing? What are the four? They are a pleasing body, pleasing speech, a pleasing mind, and a pleasing birth. How will they attain these?

"And how will they attain the four entries into the doors of dhāraṇī? What are the four? They are entry into the door of the dhāraṇī accomplished through the inexhaustible door, entry into the door of the dhāraṇī of skill in the faculties of sentient beings, entry into the door of the unconditioned dhāraṇī of skill in karma and its ripening, and entry into the door of the dhāraṇī of patience toward the profound Dharma.

"It would surely be fitting for me to put such a question to the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha."

Then the venerable Śāriputra set out at length before the Buddha, the Blessed One, the questions just as he had framed them, just as he had held them in mind, attended to them and fully understood them. And he said this as well: "Blessed One, these are the questions as I have framed them, held them in mind, attended to them and fully understood them. Please, Blessed One, explain how the conduct of these bodhisattva great beings will become completely pure through them."

When he had made this request, the Blessed One said to the venerable Śāriputra: "Excellent, Śāriputra, excellent! Śāriputra, it is also excellent that you think to ask the Tathāgata about this matter. Therefore, Śāriputra, listen well and carefully and bear it in mind, and I shall explain it to you."

The venerable Śāriputra replied, "Blessed One, that is what I wish. So be it," and he listened as the Blessed One bade. The Blessed One then said to him:

"Śāriputra, a bodhisattva great being who does not assert any phenomenon and does not grasp at any should take up these secret mantra words of the dhāraṇī:

tadyathā oṃ ane ane ane mukhe mukhe mukhe samanta mukhe jyoti saume satye satyārāme sauti yukte nirukte nirukte prabhe hili hili kalape kalape sisāre sāravati buddhavati hili hili hile hile hile hile hile hili hilile mahā hilile hile tuṇḍe caṇḍe caṇḍe carā carāṇe acale macale anante ananta gate ananta mukhe araṇe nirmale nirbhavane nirvarttane nirdānte dharma dhare nihāra nihāra vimale viśodhane śīla viśodhane prakṛti dīvane bhavane bhava vibhavane asaṃge asaṃga vihare dame śame vimale vimala prabhe samākarṣaṇe dhire dhidhire mahā dhidhire yaśo yaśovati cale acale macale

samacale ḍiḍhasanadhi susthire asaṃge asaṃga vihare asaṃga nirhare nirhara vimale nirhara viśodhane ḍiḍha some sthire sthāma sthāmavati mahā prabhe samanta prabhe vipula prabhe vipula rasmi saṃbhave samanta mukhe sarvatvānugate anācchedye pritibhane dhāraṇī nidhāne dharma nidhāni dharma nidhāna gotre samanta bhadre sarva tathāgata hṛdaya adhiṣṭhāna adhiṣṭhite svāhā

"Śāriputra, bodhisattva great beings who hold these dhāraṇīs do not form conceits about conditioned and unconditioned phenomena. They do not take them as objects, do not disparage them, do not regard them with indifference, do not grasp them, and do not set about them. They do not act for the sake of attaining them, abandoning them, cultivating them or increasing them. They do not differentiate them and do not fashion them. They do not see associated phenomena, nor do they see dissociated ones. They see neither the arising of phenomena nor their cessation. They do not see past phenomena, nor future phenomena, nor present phenomena. Nor do they see any increase or decrease of phenomena. Without accumulating any phenomenon, without diminishing it, without designating it, and without cognizing it, they cultivate solely the recollection of the Buddha.

"When they cultivate it, it is not as form, nor as the absence of form; not as the major marks, nor as the absence of the major marks; not as the excellent minor marks, nor as the absence of the excellent minor marks; not as consciousness, nor as the absence of consciousness; not as afflictions, nor as the absence of afflictions; not as moral discipline, nor as the absence of moral discipline; not as meditative absorption, nor as the absence of meditative absorption; not as wisdom, nor as the absence of wisdom; not as liberation, nor as the absence of liberation; not as the knowledge and vision of liberation, nor as the absence of the knowledge and vision of liberation; not as birth, nor as the absence of birth; not as family, nor as the absence of family; not as clan, nor as the absence of clan; not as a retinue, nor as the absence of a retinue; not as abiding, nor as the absence of abiding; not as attainment, nor as the absence of attainment; not as realization, nor as the absence of realization; not as the exhaustion of afflictions, nor as the non-exhaustion of afflictions; not as the aggregates, elements and sense bases, nor as the absence of the aggregates, elements and

sense sources. It is not without the aggregates, the elements, and the sense sources. It is not knowing, and it is not without knowing. It is not teaching the Dharma, and it is not not teaching the Dharma. It is not purifying oneself, it is

not purifying others, it is not purifying sentient beings, and it is not purifying the absence of sentient beings. It is not for one's own sake, and it is not for the sake of others. It is not as Dharma, and it is not as Vinaya. It is not purity of body, it is not purity of speech, it is not purity of mind, and it is not purity of conduct. It is not purity of conduct at the former extreme, it is not purity of conduct at the later extreme, and it is not purity of conduct arising at present. It is not in one's own mode, and it is not in another's mode. That, Śāriputra, is called the recollection of the Buddha, which is called "entering into the non-grasping of all phenomena" of the bodhisattva great beings.

This is the dhāraṇī called "Through accomplishing the ultimate, it brings attainment of fearlessness concerning the complete gathering of all phenomena." This is the samādhi called "Through definitive single-pointed attainment, it fulfills all intentions." This is the dhāraṇī called "Through accomplishing the wisdom of all roots of virtue that does not depend on others, the treasury of Dharma, the lineage of the major marks and the excellent minor marks, is not overwhelmed." This is the dhāraṇī called "Through skill in seeking the sublime, one wholly passes beyond all the deeds of māra."

Śāriputra, those bodhisattvas who attain the meaning of this Dhāraṇī of Accomplishment through the Infinite Gate will be irreversible, and will swiftly and fully awaken into unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. Why is that? Because, Śāriputra, here is assuredly the treasury of the Dharma of all buddhas and of all qualities. Because from this very dhāraṇī, endowed with conduct free of any reference point, all the conduct of bodhisattvas is distinguished; because it becomes fully differentiated.

Then at that time the Blessed One spoke these verses:

Free of doubt that phenomena are empty,
Not elaborating for the sake of awakening,
If one does not disturb the dharmadhātu,
Then the dhāraṇī will be attained.

One should listen to this sūtra;
In it the dhāraṇī is inexhaustible.
This is the very wealth of wisdom;
Through it awakening will be attained.

If a fearless bodhisattva
Fully takes up this dhāraṇī,

He will hear the Dharma teachings
Of the buddhas of the ten directions.

Of all that is set forth in meanings and syllables,
He comes to know the supreme Dharma.
As many as the rays of the sun,
So many words will he come to know.

Whatever becomes supreme among teachings,
The vast gates of dhāraṇī,
For whoever holds this sūtra
All of them are ever made manifest.

Even if all sentient beings
Were to ask him their doubts for an eon,
And all their uncertainties were cut away,
His wisdom would not be exhausted.

Whoever delights in this sūtra
Is a child of the king of Dharma,
Close to supreme awakening,
Steadfast of mind and a holder of the Dharma.

Whoever holds this dhāraṇī,
All sentient beings delight in him,
The buddhas too are pleased with him,
And his fame spreads through the world.

Whoever holds this sūtra,
When the time of death arrives,
Sees eight hundred million buddhas,
Who place their hands upon him.

For one who holds this dhāraṇī,
Whatever evil he has done before
Through a thousand koṭis of eons
Will be purified in a single month.

Whatever merit bodhisattvas
Have gathered through ten million eons,
One who holds this dhāraṇī
Surpasses all of it in a single month.

However many beings there are in the three realms,
Even if all of them were to become māras,
They could not create obstacles
For whoever holds this sūtra.

Until he attains awakening
He will have mindfulness, intelligence and realization;
Whatever is the sublime among dhāraṇīs
Will abide on the tip of his tongue.

Just as in this sūtra that has been taught
The dhāraṇī is distinctly ascertained,
From this omniscience is shown,
From this awakening will be attained.

As soon as this dhāraṇī had been explained,
The one called Dīpaṃkara prophesied me;
In that instant I saw buddhas
As many as the sands of the river Ganges.

Whoever wishes to realize here
The teaching given by all the buddhas,
By relying upon this sūtra
Will swiftly attain it all.

A pure buddha field,
An excellent assembly of śrāvakas,
And pure radiance and marks:
This sūtra will bring these about.

Therefore, being conscientious,
One who contemplates this for seven days
Will thereafter be given the dhāraṇī
By eight hundred million buddhas.

One does not think of what is to be thought as mind,
Nor does one think of what is not to be thought.
Reflect, and do not think in contradiction!
Thereafter the dhāraṇī will be attained.

Just as a person who has reached the ocean
Has no doubt about finding wealth,
So, having attained this dhāraṇī,

One has no doubt about happiness either.

Through this, perfect awakening is near;
Therefore apply yourself to this.
Having attained the state of peace,
One will attain perfect awakening.

Then the Blessed One again spoke to the venerable Śāriputra: "Śāriputra, if a bodhisattva great being possesses four qualities, he will attain this dhāraṇī. What are the four? They are these: he has no excessive attachment to sense pleasures; he has no envy toward any sentient being; he gives away all his possessions and is of a generous nature, giving without regret; and day and night he longs for the Dharma and delights in the joy of the Dharma, day and night delighting in the Dharma and longing for the Dharma. Śāriputra, if a bodhisattva great being possesses these four qualities, he will attain this dhāraṇī."

Then at that time the Blessed One spoke these verses:

"... evil, the domain where Māra roams:
Abandon foul-smelling desires.
They are the condition for beings to fall into hell,
And they are also the cause of the lower realms.
For the sake of profit, gain and fame,
Do not be jealous of others.
If you look upon beings with eyes of joy,
You will gain great power and a beautiful form.
Whenever beings fall into quarrels,
Grasping is the root and ground of it.
Therefore abandon whatever you come to crave;
When craving has been abandoned, it becomes dhāraṇī.
If you desire awakening, think of nothing else;
Seek the Dharma day and night.
If you rely on such words of Dharma as these,
The dhāraṇī will become manifest to you."

"Moreover, Śāriputra, if a bodhisattva great being possesses four qualities, he will obtain this dhāraṇī. What are the four? They are: dwelling in the wilderness and in solitude; developing the strength of patience toward the profound Dharma; having no excessive attachment to gain, honor and fame; and not

looking at anything pleasing, even to the point of giving up body and life. Śāriputra, if a bodhisattva great being possesses these four qualities, he will obtain this dhāraṇī."

Then the Blessed One, at that time, spoke these verses:

"Dwell in the wilderness the Victors have praised;
While dwelling there, do not look down on others.
Having roused your aspiration for patience toward the profound,
Abide in heedfulness as if your head were on fire.
Do not dwell in profit and gain,
Which become the ground for hypocrisy.
Like the birds, be content with meager scraps,
And make your human birth bear fruit.
Ah, you have rightly found the Buddha's teaching!
You have abandoned the household, root of much suffering.
With body, speech and mind fully purified,
Hold the Buddha and the Dharma in reverence.
Desire for gain is not mindfulness, it is not wisdom,
It is not faith, nor moral discipline, nor a mind set on Dharma.
It is as far from awakening as the sky from the earth;
Therefore gain should be entirely abandoned."

"Moreover, Śāriputra, if a bodhisattva great being possesses four qualities, he will obtain this dhāraṇī. What are the four? They are as follows: one should understand the meaning of the eight syllables. What are those eight? They are these.

pa means understanding the entry into the selflessness of all phenomena in the ultimate sense.

la means understanding the entry into the Dharma body of the Tathāgata, both with the excellent major and minor marks and without the excellent major and minor marks.

ba means understanding the entry into the nonduality, just as it is, of the qualities of the foolish and the qualities of the wise.

ja means understanding the entry into the non-arising and non-ceasing of beings, both those subject to birth, aging and death and those free of birth, aging and death.

ka means understanding the entry into karma and its maturation, and into the absence of karma and its maturation.

dha means understanding the entry into the emptiness, the signlessness, the wishlessness and the dharmadhātu of the dhāraṇī Dharma discourse.

śā means understanding the entry into the suchness of all phenomena, which is calm abiding and insight, and is without calm abiding and insight.

kṣa means that all phenomena are momentary; it is understanding the entry into inexhaustibility, fearlessness and motionlessness, because they are at peace from the very beginning, and into all phenomena being nirvāṇa.

Thus, to come to realize the understanding of the meaning of these eight syllables is the first understanding of meaning. To write out this dhāraṇī Dharma discourse well and keep it is the second understanding of meaning. To strive, every half month, always to recite this dhāraṇī Dharma discourse and to keep it in mind is the third understanding of meaning. That the bodhisattva great being who earnestly applies himself to this dhāraṇī Dharma discourse should strive to delight all beings fully, to have them truly take it up, and to lead them to true encouragement and exaltation is the fourth understanding of meaning. Śāriputra, if a bodhisattva great being possesses these four qualities, he will obtain this dhāraṇī."

Then the Blessed One, at that time, spoke these verses:

"Contemplate these eight syllables;
Write out this sūtra and keep it;
Every half month, always recite it;
And have beings also take it up.
Awakening is near, and wisdom vast and great;
Whatever buddhas dwell in the ten directions,
He sees every one of them before him.
Therefore rouse your aspiration and train in this."

"Śāriputra, these four are the benefits for a bodhisattva great being who earnestly applies himself to this dhāraṇī. What are the four? They are: all the buddhas, the blessed ones of the ten directions, keep him in mind; the deeds of Māra do not arise for him; his karmic obscurations are swiftly purified; and he swiftly obtains unbroken eloquence. Śāriputra, these four are the benefits for a bodhisattva great being who earnestly applies himself to this dhāraṇī."

Then the Blessed One, at that time, spoke these verses:

All the buddhas keep that one in mind;
Māra will find no opening against that one;
That one's karmic obscurations are swiftly cleared;
And boundless eloquence is also attained.

Śāriputra, long ago, in times gone by, countless and even more than countless eons ago, vast and far-reaching, measureless and beyond reckoning, at that time and on that occasion there appeared in the world a Tathāgata, an arhat, a perfectly complete Buddha called Like a King of the Splendor of Precious Glory. He was perfect in knowledge and conduct, a Sugata, a knower of the world, a guide who tames beings, unsurpassed, a teacher of gods and humans, a Buddha, a Blessed One.

Śāriputra, at the time when that Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha Like a King of the Splendor of Precious Glory, passed into complete nirvāṇa, there arose a wheel-turning king called Holder of Light, a lord of men possessing the seven precious things. He had a son called Glory of Inconceivable Precious Qualities. When the son had reached sixteen years of age, he heard this Dharma discourse, the Dhāraṇī of Accomplishment through the Infinite Gate, from that Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha Like a King of the Splendor of Precious Glory. As soon as he had heard this dhāraṇī, he set himself to strive in order to attain it.

For seventy thousand years he did not give himself to torpor and sleep; he was not overcome by them. Not even once did he take delight in kingship, in wealth, or in himself. For seventy thousand years he never once lay down on his side, but remained single-pointedly and steadfastly in inward concentration. He heard the Dharma taught by nine hundred million buddhas, and having heard it, he put it into practice. He retained all of it. Having put the dhāraṇī into practice, he went forth into homelessness under that very Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha Like a King of the Splendor of Precious Glory.

When ninety thousand years had passed since his going forth, he accomplished this Dhāraṇī of Accomplishment through the Infinite Gate, and having accomplished it, he taught it extensively and correctly to beings. In that single lifetime he led eight million koṭis of niyutas of beings to take up unsurpassed, perfectly complete awakening, and established them on the irreversible ground.

Śāriputra, in that assembly there was a merchant's son called Candraketu. He heard this Dharma discourse of the Dhāraṇī of Accomplishment through the Infinite Gate from that monk, the preacher of the Dharma. Having heard it, he rejoiced in it, and through the root of virtue born from that very moment of rejoicing, he heard the Dharma taught by nine hundred million buddhas. Having heard it, he put it into practice. He retained all of it. In every place he became the foremost of those who have attained dhāraṇī, the foremost of those possessed of gentle speech and of words retained as dhāraṇī, and the foremost of the bodhisattva mahāsattvas whose eloquence is unceasing. For three eons he pleased those tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly complete buddhas. Having pleased them, when three eons had passed, he became fully and completely awakened to unsurpassed, perfectly complete awakening.

Śāriputra, if you should have misgivings, or be of two minds, or harbor doubt, thinking that the one who at that time and on that occasion was the merchant's son called Candraketu was someone else, Śāriputra, you should not regard it so. And why is that? At that time and on that occasion, the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha Dīpaṃkara was the merchant's son called Candraketu.

Śāriputra, if you should have misgivings, or be of two minds, or harbor doubt, thinking that the one who at that time and on that occasion was the preacher of the Dharma called Glory of Inconceivable Precious Qualities was someone else, Śāriputra, you should not regard it so. And why is that? At that time and on that occasion, the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha Amitāyus was the monk, the preacher of the Dharma, called Glory of Inconceivable Precious Qualities.

Śāriputra, I too, together with the bodhisattva mahāsattvas of the Fortunate Eon, heard this Dharma discourse of the dhāraṇī at that time. Having heard it, we rejoiced in it, and through the root of virtue born from that very moment of rejoicing, I cut short saṃsāra by forty thousand hundred thousand koṭis of eons. I also heard the Dharma taught by nine hundred and ninety million buddhas, and in every place I became the foremost of those who have attained dhāraṇī, the foremost of those possessed of gentle speech and of words to be retained, and the foremost of the bodhisattva mahāsattvas whose eloquence is unceasing.

Therefore, Śāriputra, a bodhisattva mahāsattva who wishes swiftly to become fully and completely awakened to unsurpassed, perfectly complete awakening

should strive even just to rejoice in this Dharma discourse of the dhāraṇī. And why is that? If that alone becomes, for that bodhisattva mahāsattva, the cause of the irreversible ground for the sake of unsurpassed, perfectly complete awakening, and the cause of pleasing the preachers of the Dharma, what need is there to speak of one who writes it down, transmits it, holds it, reads it, masters it thoroughly, attends to it properly, and teaches it extensively and correctly to others? Apart from the Tathāgata, not even all sentient beings together could know or conceive the measure of that heap of merit.

Then the Blessed One spoke these verses at that time.

Having heard this sūtra, by rejoicing in it,
by writing it in letters, by holding it and reading it,
the stream of merit that one generates
could never be known even by all sentient beings.

That one will see the Victors in every lifetime,
and will find inconceivable faith in them as well;
that one will also come to know the way of the profound sūtras,
and will swiftly awaken to supreme awakening.

Even until touching unsurpassed awakening,
that one will never fall away
from samādhi, from the higher knowledges, from the dhāraṇīs,
from beauty of form, from wealth, or from seeing the buddhas.

I recall that in a former lifetime
a merchant's son heard this dhāraṇī,
and saw buddhas as many as the sands of the Ganges;
he awakened to awakening just as he wished.

Dīpaṃkara was at that time the merchant's son,
who in that former lifetime was Infinite Rays.
The preacher of the Dharma then was the Buddha Amitāyus,
and I, together with the Fortunate Eon, rejoiced.

Whoever wishes to touch awakening swiftly,
whoever wishes to conquer the māras swiftly,
whoever wishes for the excellent marks born of a hundred merits,
if they strive at this, it will not be hard to obtain.

Though someone were to fill with jewels
world systems as many as the sands of the river Ganges, and give them as

gifts,
compared with the merit of writing and holding this,
that giving would not serve even as a comparison.

Having heard this, wise bodhisattvas
who hold it single-pointedly and with conscientiousness,
or who write this dhāraṇī and reflect on it,
are said to find awakening without difficulty.

Then the Blessed One said to the venerable Śāriputra: "Śāriputra, into the body of the bodhisattva great being who strives earnestly at this Dhāraṇī of Accomplishment through the Infinite Gate, eight yakṣas who dwell in the snow mountains infuse splendor and radiance, and they guard, protect and shelter him day and night. Who are the eight? They are the yakṣa called Śūra, Steadfast, Master, Nārāyaṇabala, Intelligent in Conduct, Hard to Overcome, Terrifying, and the yakṣa called Subāhu.

"In order to make those eight yakṣas come, one should bathe thoroughly, wear thoroughly clean clothes, go to a place for walking meditation, and keep a mind free of malice toward all sentient beings. One should also bring to mind this Dharma discourse of the dhāraṇī. If one does so, those eight yakṣas will swiftly show their faces to him.

"These eight bodhisattva great beings, born among the gods who dwell in the desire realm, will also think of him. Who are the eight? They are the bodhisattva great being called Vairocana, Illuminator, Prajñāprabha, Sūryaprabha, True Exhorter, Fulfiller of All Intentions, Nakṣatrarāja, and the bodhisattva great being called Intelligent in Conduct. Those eight bodhisattva great beings will strive earnestly so that he may obtain the dhāraṇī.

"The bodhisattva great being who strives at this dhāraṇī should also make a vow of truth. He should strive earnestly to be grateful, to acknowledge kindness done to him, to long for the Dharma, to delight in the Dharma, and to have patience toward the profound Dharma. The bodhisattva great being who strives at the dhāraṇī should have the disposition of giving freely and sharing. If he should give gifts even from however little and however small, what need is there even to mention giving from much?"

When the Blessed One had taught this Dharma discourse of the dhāraṇī, hundreds of thousands of koṭis of niyutas of bodhisattvas, as many as the sands of thirty Ganges rivers, obtained this Dhāraṇī of Accomplishment through the Infinite Gate, and became irreversible from unsurpassed, perfect

and complete awakening. Beings among the gods, humans and asuras who had not previously generated the mind of awakening, numbering sixty hundred thousands of hundreds of thousands of koṭis of niyutas of multitudes, generated the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening.

Then the venerable Śāriputra said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, what is the name of this Dharma discourse? How should it be held?"

The Blessed One said: "Śāriputra, therefore hold this Dharma discourse as the Dhāraṇī of Accomplishment through the Infinite Gate. Hold it also as That Which Makes Bodhisattvas Definitely and Solely Excel. Hold it also as That Which Terrifies All Māras. Hold it also as That Which Definitely and Thoroughly Brings About the Attainment of Omniscience."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, the venerable Śāriputra, those monks, those bodhisattvas, and the world with its gods, humans, asuras and gandharvas rejoiced and praised highly what the Blessed One had said.

This concludes the sūtra called the Noble Dhāraṇī of Accomplishment through the Infinite Gate.

It was later revised in accordance with the commentary and finalized by the Indian preceptor Prajñāvarman and the editor-translator Bandé Yeshé Dé.

Translator's Notes

• Two bodhisattva names could not be identified with confidence and are translated literally: "Mind That Destroys the Darkness of All Lands" (yul may also mean "objects") and "Who Does Not Wholly Guard the Mind." The second reads oddly and may reflect a scribal variant, but it is kept as written. The very large numbers combine several Indian units, koṭi (ten million) and nayuta, multiplied by hundreds of thousands. They are rendered closely, but their exact arithmetic and the parsing of the multipliers are uncertain.
• The phrase rendered "the knowledge and vision of liberation" is the standard fifth of the five pure aggregates (vimuktijñānadarśana), following moral discipline, absorption, wisdom and liberation, which this list also contains. The piece ends mid-sentence; the list continues in the next piece.
• The verse line rendered "Of all that is set forth in meanings and syllables" reads literally "moved by meanings and syllables" (bskyod); the sense is uncertain and the rendering is interpretive. In the verses on the pure buddha field, "marks" may alternatively mean "name."
• The piece begins partway through a verse line, so the first line is incomplete.

"Fame" in the prose list renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□, which literally means "verse." The list follows the standard triad of gain, honor and fame (lābha, satkāra, śloka). In Sanskrit, śloka also means "fame," but the Tibetan translators evidently took it in its other sense, "verse."

The term □□□□□□ occurs twice. Its meaning is uncertain, and it is rendered "profit."
• The names of the ancient buddha, the wheel-turning king, and the king's son could not be

confidently identified with attested Sanskrit forms, so their meanings have been translated: Like a King of the Splendor of Precious Glory, Holder of Light, and Glory of Inconceivable Precious Qualities. In one place the text writes the dhāraṇī's title without "infinite" (sgo mtha' pas for sgo mtha' yas pas). This is evidently a scribal omission, and the full title has been translated.
• Several names of yakṣas and bodhisattvas are translated by meaning because their Sanskrit forms cannot be identified with confidence. These are Infinite Rays (the merchant's son's former name), Steadfast, Master, Intelligent in Conduct, Hard to Overcome, Terrifying, Illuminator, True Exhorter and Fulfiller of All Intentions.

The line "I, together with the Fortunate Eon, rejoiced" is literal. It likely means the Buddha together with the buddhas of the Fortunate Eon.

The large number qualifying the newly inspired beings includes a term (dkrigs pa) for an immense numeral. It is rendered here simply as "multitudes."

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.